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& F

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JAPAN & FORMOSA

FJ 10310/23

Background.

FLAG A. With reference to the Secretary of State's minute attached, it may be useful to recall here some of the earlier developments about this question.

FLAG B. The so-called "Morrison-Dulles Agreement" of June 19th last (it took the form of an agreed communique, but by subsequent agreement was never issued as such though used by both Governments in giving guidance to the press) recognised that "Japan's future attitude toward China must necessarily be for determination by Japan itself in the exercise of the sovereign and independent status contemplated by the Treaty".

FLAG C. This view was subsequently put to Mr. Yoshida, both by Mr. Morrison at San Francisco, and by Sir E. Dening in Tokyo, with the rider that Japan would be well advised to ponder the question very carefully and take no precipitate action.

Next Stage.

The United States Embassy inform me that Mr. Acheson for his part has now approved the draft formula (worked out by Mr. Scott and Mr. Merchant). (With reference to the Secretary of State's marginal note at the top of page 3 of Mr. R.H. Scott's minute, the formula did not come from Mr. Acheson but was discussed with the State Department on the understanding that it would later have to be submitted to both Secretaries of State). Mr. Acheson will by now have received the message to the effect that the Secretary of State needs more time to consider the question.

I submit a draft telegram to Paris containing a further message to Mr. Acheson as directed by the Secretary of State.

Sent by Sir Io. Strang and S. of S.
Tel. now sent.

(R.E. Barclay)
20/11

China and Korea Dept.
J. & P. Dept. DAR 21/11 Offs. 23/11. Lord Reading R. 26/11
C.A.D. 21-XI.

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(Date) 20/11 19

Despatched 8.50 p.m.

Draft.

PARIS.

[Security classification —if any] SECRET.

Addressed to PARIS.

telegram No. 1719 (date) 20/11.

repeated for information to WASHINGTON, Tokyo, Peking, Singapore and Taipei

Telegram.

No. 1719

(Date) 20 Nov

Repeat to :—

WASHINGTON. 5404.
Tokyo 1354
Peking 1481
Singapore 1049
Taipei 114

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My telegram No. 1704 [November 19th. to Japan and Formosa.]

Please pass following personal message to Mr. Acheson.

Begins.

I much appreciate frankness with which the U.S. Government have consulted us over this problem and I strongly agree on the importance of our maintaining a common front towards Japan as we have done on other questions throughout the Peace Treaty negotiations.

2. On full consideration, however, I do not feel able to approve the draft formula which emerged from the official-level talks in London last week. My predecessor and Mr. Dulles agreed in June last that Japan's future attitude towards China must be for determination by Japan itself in the exercise of the sovereign and independent status contemplated by the Peace Treaty. I stand by this agreement. I recognise that there are trade relations and other practical questions which may require contacts between the Japanese Government and the Chinese Nationalists. It

would /

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would be one thing for the Japanese Government, should they so desire, to take preliminary steps aimed at a modus vivendi covering these matters. It would be quite another thing for Japan to embark on any form of recognition of the Chinese Nationalists, and if need arose I should feel bound to endorse the advice already given the Japanese Government by Sir E. Dening ~~in this sense~~ against ~~such a course, which in our opinion would be~~ contrary to Japan's best interests.

3. In answering your proposal on these lines, I would not wish to be thought unconscious of the probable difficulties in regard to the ratification of the Peace Treaty in the United States Senate. We must, however, also consider the Parliamentary situation in this country and I should be most reluctant to do anything to jeopardise the bi-partisan acceptance which the Japanese Peace Settlement has so far received in Parliament.

Ends.

I would not wish to discourage this action. I cannot help feeling that any such action might add to Japan's and our difficulties in the future.

Distributed to
Japan and Pacific Dept
South East Asia Dept
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